

## Application for Technology Graduate Programme

Dear Asda Technology Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Technology Graduate Programme at Asda because it combines the analytical and technical work I already do with the retail technology and innovation I want to build. The opportunity to gain hands-on experience across AI, cloud, cybersecurity, web platforms, data and systems while working towards a structured development journey is exactly the environment I need to grow. I am available to start in September 2027 and comfortable with the hybrid working arrangement at Asda House, Leeds.

My background combines practical IT support and security work with formal analytical training. I am an MSc Information Security graduate from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, with CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity, preceded by a BCA in computer applications. That means I understand not only how to resolve technical problems but how to approach complex challenges in a structured way, which is central to a role that requires curiosity, problem solving and continuous learning.

In my current IT support position I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues across 15 to 20 devices, troubleshooting access and system problems, monitoring server health and maintaining network and website-access controls. I handle four to five access requests a day through on-premises Active Directory and investigate four to five suspicious emails a day, recording findings and alerting colleagues to recurring tactics. I also built a local tool that maps Windows error codes to their common causes and used it to trace intermittent server freezes to missing or corrupted DLLs. My technical skills include Python, PowerShell and SQL, which I use for task automation and data analysis.

Two things I want to be straightforward about. I have not worked in retail technology, so that domain knowledge is something I would expect to develop through Asda's graduate programme and store placements rather than claim as existing experience. What I do bring is a genuine analytical mindset and attention to detail. At Co-op, as Person in Charge, I conduct weekly risk assessments and daily compliance checks, maintain the assessment records, and coordinate seven or eight colleagues per shift while explaining requirements to people who have no particular interest in them.

What draws me to Asda specifically is the focus on shaping the systems and solutions that support millions of customers and colleagues across one of the UK's largest retailers. The opportunity to contribute to that work through a structured graduate programme with real responsibility, exposure to large-scale retail systems and support from experienced leaders is exactly the kind of challenge I am looking for. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experience could contribute to your team.

Kind regards,

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